CONTENDERS

SCOTT HIBBERT

Age: 20
Residing: Manotick, Ontario
Represents: Volkl, Tecnica, Spy, Scott USA, Boeri

Rumor has it you have a gambling problem.

What?! That's what [photographer Jeff] Winterton calls it maybe. I have fun with it, that's all. Right now I'm down a few bucks I guess.

What's your lucky game?

Blackjack and roulette. I've tried playing craps on the Internet a few times, but not for money. I'm not ready for that one yet.

So, you're a high roller then?

No.

You hold freeskiing's unofficial concussion record. How many have you racked up?

Let's see ... I've had three major concussions and three minor ones. There were probably a couple more I didn't know about.

Which crash was the gnarliest?

I'd say the worst was probably the one I had at the Molson Canadian Snow Jam in Detroit. On my first practice run I caught an edge on the transition, and it sent me up and off the right side of the ramp. I missed the pads and landed on concrete. When I woke up in the ambulance, they told me I had a concussion and a fractured shoulder. But I was at the next competition in, like, a week.

Did you have helmet sponsors banging at your door after that one?

Not really.

How have you been influenced by where you ski and who you ski with?

Ontario doesn't have the best skiing in the world, but it's great to have guys like [Dave] Crichton and [Simon] Dumont nearby to ski and shoot with. Having guys who support you and push you to get better is really important.

What was your biggest thrill of this past season?

Placing third at the WSI Superpipe Championship.

Goals for next season?

Stay healthy and air flatspin 9s way down the pipe.—**Jeff Foss**